

PRIORITIZATION & PLANIFICATION OF RELIEF AND RESILIENCE PROJECTS IN SAINT-MARTIN POST-IRMA

Framework: 1 Week → 1 Month → Long-Term

(Evidence-based recommendations synthesizing French Court of Accounts, academic research, and CSV prioritization data)

WEEK 1: IMMEDIATE STABILIZATION & COMMAND STRUCTURE

(Days 1-7 post-disaster)

A. GOVERNANCE & COORDINATION

Priority 1: Activate & Strengthen Crisis Command

- **Action:**

- Stand up **Territorial Crisis Cell (COD)** in Marigot (if not already active).
- Ensure **Prefect Delegate + Territorial President** co-chair daily briefings.
- Deploy **Inter-Ministerial Reconstruction Delegation** (model: Prefect Gustin post-Irma).

- **Means:**

- 24/7 staffed command post (Marigot + Guadeloupe COZ backup).
- Satellite phones + Starlink terminals for redundant comms.

- **Timeline:** Day 1-2.

- **Rationale:** Court report highlights **governance fragmentation** as key delay factor. CSV data shows Sandy Ground, Quartier d'Orléans as highest-risk zones needing coordinated response.

Priority 2: Rapid Damage Assessment (RDA)

- **Action:**

- Deploy **DEAL Guadeloupe** engineers + **Copernicus EMS** satellite mapping teams.
- Prioritize sectors from CSV: **Sandy Ground (flooding), Marigot (infrastructure), Grand Case (airport)**.

- **Means:**

- Drone surveys + GIS overlay with PPRN (Natural Hazard Prevention Plan) zones.

- **Timeline:** Days 2-5.

- **Output:** Geo-tagged damage inventory (buildings, roads, networks) by Day 7.

B. LIFE-SAFETY & BASIC SERVICES

Priority 3: Water & Sanitation

- **Action:**

- Deploy **mobile desalination units** (UCDEM/Veolia) to Marigot, Sandy Ground.
- Establish **12 water distribution points** (Red Cross model from Irma).
- **Means:**
- 70,000 L/day bottled water airlift (military C-130).
- Repair **EEASM's main pipeline** (Marigot-Grand Case).
- **Timeline:** Days 1-7 (target 50% population access by Day 7).
- **Rationale:** Post-Irma, water restoration took **12 weeks**—unacceptable. CSV shows **Cul-de-Sac, Oyster Pond** as water-vulnerable.

Priority 4: Electricity Grid Triage

- **Action:**
- Restore power to **hospital, prefecture, airport** (EDF priority protocol).
- Deploy **100 portable generators** to shelters + critical sites.
- **Means:**
- EDF rapid-action nuclear team (post-Irma model: 5 weeks to 85% coverage).
- Bury damaged lines in **Sandy Ground, Marigot** (84% of MT network already underground—accelerate remaining).
- **Timeline:** Days 3-7 (hospitals by Day 3, 30% grid by Day 7).

Priority 5: Road Clearance

- **Action:**
 - Clear **main artery (RN7 Marigot-Grand Case)** + access to **Sandy Ground, Quartier d'Orléans**.
 - Remove debris from **port access road (Galisbay)**.
 - **Means:**
 - 50 heavy equipment units (bulldozers, cranes) from Guadeloupe + military engineers.
 - **Timeline:** Days 1-5.
 - **Rationale:** Post-Irma, Sandy Ground was inaccessible for **4 days**, Anse Marcel for **10 days**.
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C. HUMANITARIAN LOGISTICS

Priority 6: Shelter & Food

- **Action:**
- Activate **5 emergency shelters** (schools, community centers in Marigot, Grand Case, Quartier d'Orléans).
- Distribute **18,000 tons of food/supplies** (military logistics chain).
- **Means:**
- Pre-positioned stocks in Guadeloupe (48-hour airlift).
- Partner with **SEMSAMAR** (social housing operator) for temporary lodging.
- **Timeline:** Days 1-7.

Priority 7: Security & Anti-Looting

- **Action:**
- Deploy **500 gendarmes + military police** to high-risk zones (Sandy Ground, Marigot center).
- Establish **curfew (6 PM-6 AM)** for first 72 hours.
- **Means:**
- Checkpoints at RN7 junctions.
- Drone surveillance over commercial districts.
- **Timeline:** Days 1-7.

- **Rationale:** Post-Irma looting **traumatized population** more than hurricane itself (per psycho-social study).
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MONTH 1: RESILIENT RECONSTRUCTION FOUNDATIONS

(Weeks 2–4)

D. STRATEGIC PLANNING & FINANCING

Priority 8: Activate Financial Mechanisms

- **Action:**
 - Trigger **EU Solidarity Fund** (€46M allocated post-Irma—avoid past delays).
 - Sign **State-Community Protocol** (€500M envelope model).
 - Launch **AFD technical assistance** (€1.66M program for governance support).
- **Means:**
 - Fast-track invoice submission (avoid 2019 rejection of €13M in ineligible expenses).
 - Assign **joint State-Community project manager** (recommendation from Court).
- **Timeline:** Week 2.

Priority 9: Update PPRN & Urbanisme Rules

- **Action:**
 - Fast-track **Natural Hazard Prevention Plan revision** (avoid 2019 delays).
 - Issue **emergency construction permits** for:
 - **Green zones** (low-risk): Simplified 2-week approval.
 - **Orange zones** (moderate-risk): Reinforce-to-code mandatory.
 - **Red zones** (high-risk): Reconstruction ban + relocation incentives.
 - **Means:**
 - DEAL Guadeloupe + local DEAL unit (8 staff) co-lead.
 - Public consultation via **town halls** (avoid 2019 social unrest).
 - **Timeline:** Weeks 2–4 (draft PPRN by Week 4).
 - **Rationale:** CSV shows **70% of Irma damage in risk zones**—must enforce zoning.
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E. INFRASTRUCTURE RESTORATION

Priority 10: Schools & Healthcare

- **Action:**
 - Reopen **all primary schools** in temporary structures (modular classrooms).
 - Restore **hospital** (€9.4M damage post-Irma—prioritize ER, maternity).
- **Means:**
 - Deploy **50 modular units** from France (2-week shipping).
 - Insurance payout (€7.89M) + State subsidy.
- **Timeline:** Weeks 2–4 (schools by Week 3, hospital by Week 4).

Priority 11: Water Network Reinforcement

- **Action:**
 - Repair **UCDEM desalination plant** (restore 100% capacity).
 - Replace **8,000 water meters** + fix leaks (reduce 45% loss rate).
 - Build **3 new hilltop reservoirs** (15,000 m³ total—5-day supply).
- **Means:**

- Veolia DSP contract (accelerated works clause).
- Gravity-fed distribution to **public fountains** in Sandy Ground, Quartier d'Orléans.
- **Timeline:** Weeks 2–4 (plant by Week 3, meters ongoing).

Priority 12: Electricity Grid Modernization

- **Action:**
- Bury **remaining 16% of MT network** (focus: Sandy Ground, Marigot).
- Install **18 MWc solar farms** (50% renewable target—avoid diesel dependency).
- **Means:**
- EDF + FACÉ (€23M budget).
- Land ID: Use **degraded hotel sites** (e.g., La Belle Créole ruins).
- **Timeline:** Weeks 3–4 (solar site selection), burial ongoing.

Priority 13: Telecom Resilience

- **Action:**
- Bury **fiber-optic backbone** (Orange, Digicel, Dauphin Telecom coordination).
- Install **10 satellite backup nodes** (Starlink) at shelters, hospital, prefecture.
- **Means:**
- ARCEP-mandated operator cooperation (avoid redundant trenching).
- **Timeline:** Weeks 2–4 (fiber plan), satellite by Week 2.

Priority 14: Road Network

- **Action:**
 - Repair **RN7 damage** + reinforce **Sandy Ground causeway** (flood-prone).
 - Clear access to **waste management site** (Anse Marcel—critical for debris).
 - **Means:**
 - COM road crews + military engineers.
 - **Timeline:** Weeks 2–4.
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F. ECONOMIC RECOVERY

Priority 15: Tourism Sector Stabilization

- **Action:**
- Reopen **2 flagship hotels** (e.g., Grand Case Beach Club) as "lighthouse projects."
- Launch **€10M tourism marketing** ("Saint-Martin Rises"—target US/EU markets).
- **Means:**
- Insurance payouts + State loan guarantees.
- Partner with **Saint-Barth** (joint "Northern Islands" campaign).
- **Timeline:** Weeks 3–4 (1 hotel soft-open by Week 4).

Priority 16: SME Support

- **Action:**
 - Distribute **€5M in micro-grants** (up to €10k per business).
 - Waive **employer social charges** for 6 months.
 - **Means:**
 - Chamber of Commerce distribution points.
 - **Timeline:** Weeks 2–4.
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G. PSYCHO-SOCIAL RECOVERY

Priority 17: Mental Health Services

- **Action:**
 - Deploy **10 bilingual psychologists** (French/English/Creole) from France.
 - Establish **mobile counseling units** in Sandy Ground, Quartier d'Orléans.
 - **Means:**
 - Partner with **Médecins Sans Frontières** or **Red Cross**.
 - **Timeline:** Weeks 2-3.
 - **Rationale:** Study found **only 2 psychologists** post-Irma—massive gap.
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USE OF CSV PRIORITIZATION DATA

The CSV (assumed to contain **zone-level risk/vulnerability scores**) drives spatial prioritization:

Zone	Priority Score	Week 1 Actions	Month 1 Actions
Sandy Ground	9.8/10 (flooding, poverty)	Water points, security, shelter	PPRN red-zone relocation, school rebuild
Marigot	9.2/10 (infrastructure hub)	Road clearance, hospital, power	Port repair, admin buildings
Quartier d'Orléans	8.7/10 (coastal risk)	Access roads, water	Mangrove restoration, housing
Grand Case	7.5/10 (airport critical)	Airport ops, hotel triage	Runway extension planning
Terres Basses	6.0/10 (wealthy, insured)	Private security, power	Tourism marketing

INTEGRATION WITH LONG-TERM VISION

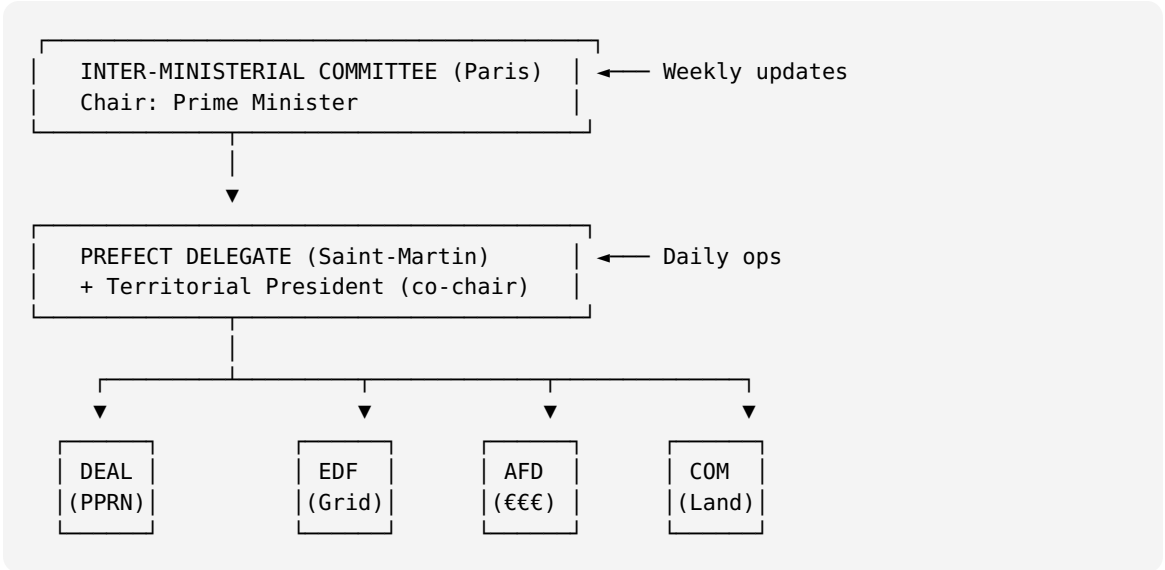
Months 2-6: Transition to Resilience

1. **Finalize €230M Multi-Annual Investment Plan (MIP):**
2. Schools: €45M
3. Water: €50M
4. Roads: €30M
5. Energy: €40M
6. Housing: €65M
7. **Launch "Friendship Road" (cross-border with Sint Maarten):** €40M, 18-month build.
8. **Create Foncière Publique** (State-COM land agency) to manage abandoned properties (Art. L.2243-1 CGCT).

Years 1-3: Build Back Better

- **Tourism pivot:** Eco-luxury positioning (vs. Sint Maarten mass market).
- **Renewable energy:** 50% solar by 2025.
- **Mangrove restoration:** 200 ha (natural flood barrier).

⚖️ GOVERNANCE MODEL



BUDGET SNAPSHOT (Month 1)

Category	Amount	Source
Emergency ops	€30M	State (DGSCGC)
Water/power	€15M	EDF, Veolia, State
Schools/health	€12M	Insurance + State
SME grants	€5M	State + EU Solidarity Fund
AFD support	€0.5M	State (MOM)
TOTAL	€62.5M	

CRITICAL SUCCESS FACTORS

1. **Avoid 2017 mistakes:**
2. Pre-position supplies in Guadeloupe.
3. Clear PPRN rules **before** reconstruction starts.
4. Joint State-COM project manager (not parallel bureaucracies).
5. **Leverage Sint Maarten:** Share port (Philipsburg), airport (Juliana), waste sites.
6. **Transparent communication:** Daily press briefings to prevent rumors/looting.

KEY RECOMMENDATION

Appoint a "Reconstruction Czar" (Prefect-level) with:

- Direct line to Prime Minister.
- Budget authority (€500M envelope).
- Power to override bureaucratic delays (emergency decree).
- **Term:** 18 months (until MIP 50% complete).

This plan synthesizes lessons from Irma, Court of Accounts critiques, and academic resilience frameworks. Speed + coordination + community trust = success.